LAF YOMI

Bekhorot 33 · October 21, 2026

ON TODAY'S DAF

Bekhorot 33 finishes the bekhor-baal-mum sugyot on 33a: the Beit Shammai/Beit Hillel machloket over feeding a bekhor to a non-kohen (with the עבודה pircha and Rabbi Akiva's כצבי וכאיל leniency — even for a non-Jew), the מרגילין skinning ban on Yom Tov, and Rabbi Elazar bar Rabbi Shimon on sanctified remnants. 33b opens the new Mishnah — בכור שאחזו דם, therapeutic bloodletting for a clotted firstborn — and the gemara's גרמא discussion: even indirect blemishing of a bekhor is banned (לגרמא הוא דאתי).

מאכילין בכור · DOES THE GUEST ACQUIRE THE HOST'S FOOD? (THE MAHARIT'S APPLE-KIDDUSHIN)



1. To test whether a guest acquires the food on his host's table, Lebowitz quotes the Maharit's teshuva: a guest who grabs an apple off the serving tray and uses it to betroth his friend's daughter — then acts out the guy recruiting his witnesses.

“First of course he says to two people at the table, "עדים, עדים? You're not related? Good." So he has two people serve as עדים and he does a קידושין.”

— Rabbi Lebowitz

In the daf: Bekhorot 33a · הטמא והטהור יאכלנו — who may eat the bekhor · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Aryeh Lebowitz · 11:53

לגרמא הוא דאתי · כל מום לא יהיה בו — THE INDIRECT-BLEMISH BAN



2. On the ban against even indirectly blemishing a bekhor, Elefant reads the baraita's test case deadpan: smear honey-cake on the animal's ear so a passing dog does the deed for you.

“מנין שלא יביא דבילה ובצק ויניחנה על אוזן הבכור כדי שיבא כלב ויאכלנה, that a dog will come and bite it and make the animal the בכור into a בעל מום?”

— Rabbi Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 33b · לגרמא הוא דאתי — the honey-cake-on-the-ear baraita · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Moshe Elefant · 52:30

זר ועבודה · THE טמא PIRCHA — NOBODY MAY DO THE AVODAH



3. Refuting Beit Hillel's kal vachomer, Lebowitz stages the scene: the Mikdash arrives tomorrow, nobody is qualified to serve, and everyone in the courtyard is looking around helplessly.

“even if מהרה יבנה המקדש and no one has any idea how to do the עבודה, and we're going to be looking for someone, "Anyone know what to do over here?" right?”

— Rabbi Lebowitz

In the daf: Bekhorot 33a · the עבודה pircha — מה לטמא שכן הותר מכללו בעבודת ציבור · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Aryeh Lebowitz · 8:35

LAF YOMI

Bekhorot 33 · October 21, 2026

בכור שאחזו דם · THE BLOODLETTING MISHNAH



4. Reading the new Mishnah on therapeutic bloodletting for a clotted bekhor, Lebowitz translates Rabbi Yehuda's ban into nursery-school English.

“Even if it's not going to make a מום קבוע through the הכזה, it's just going to make a little boo-boo and it's going to get better.”

— Rabbi Lebowitz

In the daf: Bekhorot 33b · אפילו מת אין מקיזין — בכור שאחזו דם · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Aryeh Lebowitz · 32:10

שמא יבוא אליהו ויטהרנה · חבית של תרומה



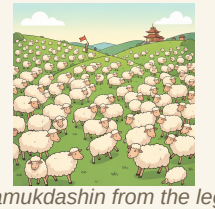
5. Why guard a barrel of doubtful terumah instead of leaving it exposed? Rabbi Eliezer's answer — שמא יבוא אליהו ויטהרנה — gets the first-person treatment, with Eliyahu himself delivering the ruling in chatty English.

“is because there's still hope! אליהו הנביא might come and tell us that, "Oh, you had a ספק? Is it טמא, is it טהור? I'll tell you it's טהור!”

— Rabbi Lebowitz

In the daf: Bekhorot 33b · שמא יבוא אליהו ויטהרנה — the doubtful-terumah barrel · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Aryeh Lebowitz · 36:54

גזירה שמא יגדל מהן עדרים עדרים · הרגלה



6. Rabbi Yosi bar Avin bans skinning pesulei hamukdashin from the legs, lest owners wait for hide-market prices and amass herds of half-holy animals — Lebowitz's deadpan summary of the gezeirah.

“so we just don't want so many קדוש animals walking around.”

— Rabbi Lebowitz

In the daf: Bekhorot 33b · גזירה שמא יגדל מהן עדרים עדרים — no leg-skinning the hides · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Aryeh Lebowitz · 31:39